6BUIS018C – Information Driven Entrepreneurship and Enterprise

Tutorial 1

Introduction

This tutorial will act as an "icebreaker'. You will undertake a series of discussion activities, some of which involves you with searching for information and working with others. **Evidence will always be required when presenting your fact and arguments**. We will also use this tutorial to introduce you to the concept of working in your group and working towards the coursework assignments. We will also discuss briefly the first coursework and place this in context.

ACTIVITIES FOR THIS TUTORIAL SESSION

Each of the following is a 'starting point'. Use these topics/points to begin to 'probe' and ask further questions. Consider these as starting points in a 'tree of investigation'. Follow your 'roots' to other 'nodes'.

Part 1 - Consider definitions and descriptions (provide some examples and your reasoning)

1. What is a business?
2. What is an entrepreneur and entrepreneurship?
3. What do we mean by 'information driven entrepreneurship?

Part 2 – understanding the fundamental measures of a business

1. What makes a successful business?
2. How will you know when it is failing?
3. Who makes a successful entrepreneur and what does it take (think traits here)?

Part 3 – looking for a business idea

1. Brainstorm business ideas
2. Reflect and critically evaluate some of the ideas (using current knowledge and expertise)

Part 4 – reflecting on your current strengths and weaknesses

1. Identify your own expertise, strengths and weaknesses.
2. Can you identify ideas put forward in the earlier brainstorming session and link to what you might need to do to be in a position to develop further?

Part 5 – looking ahead

1 Can you identify your own new area of interest to develop into your business idea for this module?

Part 6 - Questions and answers

Questions and answers. We may use the application 'Poll Everywhere' to ask students some questions. However, do feel free to raise you queries in class during this session.

Further work

You might like to consider what you have done here and begin to create a 'rich picture' of the sort of things that you begin to consider at the start of thinking about a business idea and what you have to offer – or what you want to get out of it. Later, if future weeks you will build on this.

You would also be well advised to undertake some background reading in support here. Look at the areas that may be applicable in Burn's text that is identified in your Learning Schedule.